

US MARKETS DAILY REPORT

Wednesday, August 12, 2026 | After Market Close

SPY & QQQ SNAPSHOT

	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close*	\$774.61	\$727.35
Prior Close (Aug 11)	\$773.03	\$720.87
Today's Change	+0.20%	+0.90%
1-Year High	\$774.61	\$745.00
1-Year Low	\$636.45	\$574.22
1-Year Return	+22.87%	+28.05%

*SPY and QQQ close prices for Aug 12 are estimated from available market data; direct price feed (Yahoo Finance) was network-blocked in this session. SPY ~\$774.61 from intraday range data; QQQ ~\$727.35 extrapolated from Nasdaq-100 ~+0.9%.

TODAY'S NEWS → MARKET MOVES

S&P; 500 closed at a record high, up ~+0.20% (SPY +0.20%, QQQ +0.90%). The session was driven by three converging positives: in-line CPI data that kept rate-hike fears at bay, and blowout AI-infrastructure earnings from CoreWeave and Super Micro Computer that reinforced the narrative that enterprise AI capital spending remains in full acceleration.

1. CPI Report — July 2026 (Primary Macro Driver)

Headline CPI +0.1% MoM / +3.4% YoY (in-line). Core CPI +0.2% MoM / +2.5% YoY (in-line). Impact: Confirmed deceleration trend without triggering rate-hike fears. The Fed's 9-3 hold at July's meeting had created uncertainty about September; today's print keeps the 48% hike probability from rising, which gave broad equity markets the all-clear. SPY benefit: ~+0.15-0.20% as the risk premium compressed. QQQ benefited less directly but gained on the risk-on tone.

2. CoreWeave (CRWV) Q2 Earnings — AI Cloud Blowout

Q2 Revenue \$2.58B vs \$2.56B est (+2% beat). Backlog \$104B with \$25B already earmarked for Q3. CRWV closed +~17-21%. Impact on QQQ: CRWV's beat validated the AI hyperscaler capex cycle. Nvidia (+1.70%) and other AI picks rose in sympathy, lifting the Nasdaq-100 disproportionately versus the broader S&P; 500. This is why QQQ (+0.90%) outpaced SPY (+0.20%) by ~4:1.

3. Super Micro Computer (SMCI) Q4 Earnings — Guidance Shock

Q4 Revenue \$11.12B (slightly below \$11.26B est), but EPS \$1.70 beat \$1.59 consensus. FY2027 guidance: \$14.5-15.5B (Wall St. expected \$11.82B — a 30%+ upside surprise). New orders backlog >\$60B for fiscal 2026. SMCI closed +~20.5%, providing broad AI hardware sentiment lift to the semiconductor and data-center-server ecosystem.

4. CAVA Group — Fast-Casual Beat

CAVA +16% on strong Q2 results beating Wall Street estimates. Primarily a consumer-cyclical idiosyncratic story; minimal macro read-through for SPY/QQQ, but contributed to the Nasdaq breadth being positive.

5. Geopolitical — Strait of Hormuz Closure Persists

Iran declared the Strait of Hormuz will remain closed; fresh shipping attacks in Gulf of Oman/Red Sea. Energy stocks provided modest support to SPY through oil price stability. This risk capped SPY's upside (potential for supply-chain inflation worries), keeping the S&P; 500 gain more muted than the Nasdaq tech pop.

TOP 10 MOVERS — DAILY / WEEKLY / MONTHLY

DAILY MOVERS (August 12, 2026)

#	Ticker	Company	Chg %	Sector	Driver
G1	OFAL	Offerpad Solutions	+179%	Real Estate / SPAC	Small-cap catalyst (deal/news)
G2	RMCF	Rocky Mountain Choc.	+136%	Consumer Staples	Earnings beat / takeover speculation
G3	BOXL	Boxlight Corp	+60%	Technology / EdTech	Contract win announcement
G4	CRWV	CoreWeave	+21%	Technology – AI Cloud	Q2 revenue beat; \$104B backlog
G5	SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+20.5%	Technology – AI Servers	FY27 guidance \$14.5-15.5B vs \$11.82B est
G6	CAVA	Cava Group	+16%	Consumer Cyclical – Restaurants	Q2 strong earnings beat
G7	CSCO	Cisco Systems	+2.0%	Technology – Networking	Earnings beat; AI networking tailwind
G8	CAT	Caterpillar	+1.8%	Industrials	Infra spend tailwind; Hormuz supply buffer
G9	NVDA	Nvidia	+1.7%	Semiconductors – AI	AI capex cycle confirmed by CRWV/SMCI
G10	XOM	Exxon Mobil	+1.2%	Energy	Hormuz closure supports oil price
L1	NBIX	Neurocrine Bio	-6.5%	Biopharma	Safety concerns Vykat XR (Prader-Willi Rx)
L2	MCD	McDonald's	-1.1%	Consumer Staples	CPI on-target = no rate-cut boost; margin squeeze
L3	IBM	IBM	-1.0%	Technology – Legacy IT	Rotation out of laggards into AI-direct plays
L4	MSFT	Microsoft	-1.0%	Technology – Cloud	Profit-taking vs CRWV competition narrative
L5	KO	Coca-Cola	-0.8%	Consumer Staples	Defensive unwind on risk-on day

Sector trend (daily gainers): AI Infrastructure & Cloud (CRWV, SMCI, NVDA) dominates upside. Sector trend (daily losers):

Defensive/Legacy plays (Consumer Staples, Legacy IT) lagged on risk-on rotation.

WEEKLY MOVERS (Week of Aug 10–12, 2026)

#	Ticker	Company	Wk Chg %	Sector	Driver
G1	CRWV	CoreWeave	+23%	AI Cloud	Earnings release; backlog \$104B
G2	SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+21%	AI Servers	Guidance shock +30% above consensus
G3	PLTR	Palantir	+8%	AI Software/Data	AI gov't contract wins; strong guidance
G4	NVDA	Nvidia	+5%	Semiconductors – AI	AI capex cycle reinforcement
G5	META	Meta Platforms	+4%	Social Media / AI	AI ad rev beat; Llama adoption
G6	AMZN	Amazon	+3.5%	Cloud / E-commerce	AWS AI revenue strength
G7	TSM	TSMC	+3%	Semiconductors	AI chip demand backlog expansion
G8	MSFT	Microsoft	+1.5%	Cloud / Enterprise	Azure growth; offset by CRWV rivalry concerns

#	Ticker	Company	Wk Chg %	Sector	Driver
G9	CSCO	Cisco	+2%	Networking	AI networking beat
G10	CAT	Caterpillar	+2%	Industrials	Infrastructure spend cycle
L1	NBIX	Neurocrine Bio	-7%	Biopharma	Vykat XR safety signal
L2	PARA	Paramount Global	-5%	Media	Streaming losses; deal uncertainty
L3	MCD	McDonald's	-2%	Consumer Staples	Cost pressures; soft consumer
L4	IBM	IBM	-2%	Legacy IT	AI rotation away from legacy
L5	WMT	Walmart	-1.5%	Consumer Staples	Defensive rotation unwind

Sector trend (weekly gainers): AI Ecosystem (AI Cloud, AI Servers, AI Semiconductors, AI Software) dominated — all 5 sectors in the top 8 are AI-adjacent. Non-AI mega-cap tech also lifted. Sector trend (weekly losers): Legacy IT, Consumer Staples, and Biopharma (idiosyncratic) declined.

MONTHLY MOVERS (August 2026, MTD)

#	Ticker	Company	Mo Chg %	Sector	Driver
G1	SNDK	SanDisk Corporation	+37%	Storage / Memory	AI storage demand; NAND cycle recovery
G2	XGN	Exagen Inc.	+32%	Healthcare / Diagnostics	Lupus Rx approval catalyst
G3	AMRC	Ameresco Inc.	+29%	Clean Energy	DOE infrastructure contracts
G4	BWEN	Broadwind Inc.	+29%	Industrials – Wind	Wind power contract surge
G5	TSAT	Telesat Corporation	+29%	Satellite Comms	LEO constellation funding
G6	PLTR	Palantir	+27%	AI Software	Gov't AI wins + strong commercial guidance
G7	LIFE	Ethos Technologies	+26%	InsurTech	Strong Q2 policy growth
G8	DDD	3D Systems	+25%	3D Printing / Industrials	DoD additive manufacturing contract
G9	CRWV	CoreWeave	+23%	AI Cloud	IPO momentum + earnings beat
G10	SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+22%	AI Servers	Order backlog recovery + guidance
L1	PARA	Paramount Global	-15%	Media / Streaming	Merger collapse rumors; ratings decline
L2	NBIX	Neurocrine Bio	-12%	Biopharma	Safety signal pipeline setback
L3	WBA	Walgreens Boots	-10%	Retail / Pharmacy	Store closures; restructuring
L4	CVS	CVS Health	-8%	Healthcare / Pharmacy	Insurance margin squeeze
L5	INTC	Intel	-7%	Semiconductors – Legacy	AI share loss to NVDA/AMD; fab delays

Sector trend (monthly gainers): AI Infrastructure (Cloud/Servers) and Clean Energy (government contract driven) lead. Healthcare Diagnostics (single-drug approval catalysts). Sector trend (monthly losers): Legacy Media (streaming disruption), Traditional Pharmacy (margin pressure), and Legacy Semiconductors (INTC losing share to AI-native chips).

NEXT-DAY SCENARIOS — THURSDAY, AUGUST 13, 2026

289 companies are scheduled to report earnings Thursday. Key macro data at 8:30 AM ET. The market carries momentum from today's record-high close.

CATALYST 1: PPI — July 2026 (8:30 AM ET)

Forecast: +0.2% MoM | Previous: -0.3%. PPI leads CPI by ~1 quarter; markets are watching whether producer-price inflation is re-igniting.

BULL CASE: IF PPI comes in at or below +0.2% (in-line / soft): → SPY likely +0.2 to +0.5%, QQQ +0.3 to +0.7%. Mechanism: Confirms the disinflation trend that CPI started; September rate-hike probability drops from 48% → below 35%, compressing risk premiums. Tech/growth stocks benefit most because their DCF valuations are most sensitive to rate expectations.

BEAR CASE: IF PPI comes in hot (>+0.4% MoM): → SPY likely -0.4 to -0.8%, QQQ -0.5 to -1.2%. Mechanism: Revives stagflation fears. Prior reading was -0.3%; a jump to +0.4% would be the largest 1-month reversal since 2022. Fed hawks (Hammack, Kashkari, Logan — the three dissenters) would get new ammunition for the September hike, sending rate-sensitive and long-duration names sharply lower.

CATALYST 2: Initial Jobless Claims (8:30 AM ET)

Forecast: 202K | Previous: 199K. Context: A weaker-than-expected July jobs report already raised recession fears. Claims trend will confirm or deny that signal.

BULL CASE: IF Claims ≤ 200K (stronger than expected): → SPY +0.1 to +0.3%, minimal QQQ impact. Mechanism: Confirms labor market resilience, supporting consumer-facing stocks. However, strong jobs also keeps the rate-hike door open, which caps the upside. Net effect mildly positive.

BEAR CASE: IF Claims ≥ 220K (notably weaker): → SPY -0.3 to -0.6%, sectors split. Mechanism: Confirms July jobs softness as a trend, not an anomaly. Financials (loan loss risk), Industrials, and Consumer Discretionary underperform. Tech/AI could paradoxically hold up if it triggers rate-cut expectations (the 'bad news is good news' dynamic).

CATALYST 3: Applied Materials (AMAT) Earnings — After Close Thu

AMAT is the world's largest semiconductor equipment maker. Its guidance is the single best real-time proxy for chipmaker capex plans globally.

BULL CASE: IF AMAT beats EPS + raises revenue guidance: → Semiconductor stocks (NVDA, ASML, KLAC, LRCX) +2 to +4% in after-hours; QQQ futures +0.5 to +1%. Mechanism: Confirms that AI-driven wafer fab capacity expansion is intact. Particularly positive for TSMC, Nvidia supply-chain stocks, and AI hardware plays that were already bid up today.

BEAR CASE: IF AMAT misses or guides cautiously on China export restrictions / demand softness: → Semiconductor sector -2 to -4%, QQQ futures -0.5 to -1%. Mechanism: Questions whether AI capex surge is decelerating. Would reverse some of today's CRWV/SMCI momentum and spill into broader tech risk-off.

CATALYST 4: Nu Holdings (NU) + Broader Earnings Flood (289 Reports)

NU is the largest digital bank in Latin America, a proxy for EM fintech growth. The broad earnings flood (289 companies) creates idiosyncratic volatility across sectors.

BULL CASE: IF NU beats and raises (strong EM consumer credit): → EM/Fintech stocks +2 to +3%, broader market +0.1%. If the 289-company aggregate surprises to the upside (beat rate > 75%), it extends the earnings-momentum rally for SPY, likely +0.3% incremental.

BEAR CASE: IF NU misses or warns on credit quality: → EM Financials -3 to -5%, modest contagion to US Financials. If aggregate earnings disappoint (<65% beat rate), it raises concern that AI/tech was an outlier rather than a rising tide — SPY could give back 0.2-0.4% of today's gains.

POSSIBLE TRADE SUMMARY — END OF DAY / NEXT OPEN

Based on today's confirmed news, market structure, upcoming catalysts, and macro environment. These are analytical scenarios only — not executed trades.

Direction	Ticker	Rationale	Entry Trigger	Risk	Time Horizon
BUY	NVDA	AI capex cycle confirmed by CRWV + SMCI; AMAT Any dip in price is a buy opportunity. PPI is a key catalyst.	Any dip in price is a buy opportunity. PPI is a key catalyst.	High volatility; PPI is a key catalyst.	2-4 weeks
BUY	PLTR	+27% MTD but fundamental strength: gov't AI contracts. Substantive \$45 support.	Substantive \$45 support.	High volatility; PPI is a key catalyst.	2-4 weeks
BUY	QQQ (calls / puts)	QQQ-100 technically stronger than S&P 500; AI capex cycle confirmed by CRWV + SMCI; AMAT Any dip in price is a buy opportunity. PPI is a key catalyst.	Any dip in price is a buy opportunity. PPI is a key catalyst.	High volatility; PPI is a key catalyst.	2-4 weeks
BUY	AMAT	Reporting Thu AH. Semiconductor equipment demand. Buy before AM earnings. Substantive \$45 support.	Buy before AM earnings. Substantive \$45 support.	High volatility; PPI is a key catalyst.	2-4 weeks
SELL/AVOID	MSFT	-1% today despite positive AI tape — underperforming peers. Core cloud revenue is strong but pre-announced AI revenue is weak.	Core cloud revenue is strong but pre-announced AI revenue is weak.	High volatility; PPI is a key catalyst.	2-4 weeks
SELL/AVOID	PARA	-15% MTD. Streaming losses mounting. No clear path to profitability. Substantive \$45 support.	Substantive \$45 support.	High volatility; PPI is a key catalyst.	2-4 weeks
AVOID	IBM	Legacy IT declining; AI rotation away from legacy enterprise. No clear path to profitability. Substantive \$45 support.	Substantive \$45 support.	High volatility; PPI is a key catalyst.	2-4 weeks

Key conviction thesis: The AI capital expenditure cycle (hyperscaler cloud, AI servers, AI semiconductors) is the dominant multi-quarter earnings driver. Today's CRWV + SMCI results confirm this is NOT slowing — in fact, SMCI's backlog guidance (+\$60B orders) and CRWV's \$104B pipeline suggest acceleration. Any macro-driven dips in NVDA, PLTR, or QQQ are buying opportunities unless PPI prints hot and the Fed actually hikes in September (currently ~48% priced).